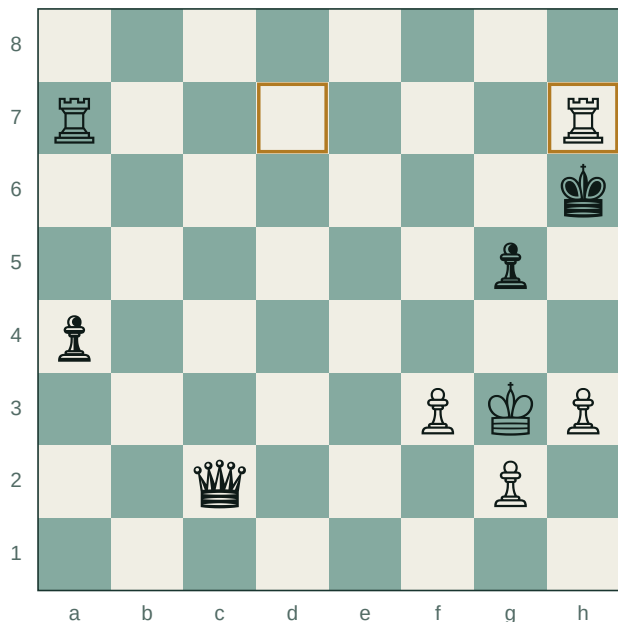


Queen-and-rook endings: Black, move 42

Queen-and-rook endings

Black to move



Previous move: 42.Rxh7+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

42...Qxh7 43. Rxa4 Qc7+

42...Qxh7 The queen captures the rook on h7. Recorded reply: **43.Rxa4**.

43...Qc7+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here.

At the end, nominal material is White 8 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from -2 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on g3. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.